README

China’s Global Public Diplomacy Dashboard Dataset (Version 3.0)

September 30, 2022

This dataset is composed of first-of-its-kind quantifiable data on People's Republic of China's (PRC) global public diplomacy efforts from several of AidData's reports (including: *Ties That Bind*, *Influencing the Narrative, Silk Road Diplomacy, Listening to Leaders 2021,* and *Corridors of Power*) and datasets (including: AidData's Global Chinese Development Finance Dataset, Version 2.0 and China Global Public Diplomacy Dataset Version 1.6) is available through AidData's China's Global Public Diplomacy Dashboard. This includes metrics for five types of public diplomacy: financial, cultural, elite-to-elite, exchange, and informational. It also includes several measures of how China is perceived by leaders in countries that receive its Public Diplomacy overtures. Using the dashboard you can create custom data sets, maps and graphs based on the type of public diplomacy, recipient countries and time periods in which you are specifically interested.

Below are the citations for the supporting reports and datasets from this dataset is drawn:
Custer, S., Russell, B. DiLorenzo, M., Cheng, M., Ghose, S., Sims, J., Turner, J., and H. Desai. (2018). *Ties That Bind: Quantifying China's public diplomacy and its "good neighbor" effect.* Williamsburg, VA: AidData at William & Mary.

Custer, S., Prakash, M., Solis, J., Knight, R., and J. Lin. (2019). *Influencing the Narrative: How the Chinese government mobilizes students and media to burnish its image*. Williamsburg, VA. AidData at William & Mary.

Custer, S., Sethi, T., Solis, J., Lin, J., Ghose, S., Gupta, A., Knight, R., and A. Baehr. (2019). *Silk Road Diplomacy: Deconstructing Beijing's toolkit to influence South and Central Asia*. December 10, 2019. Williamsburg, VA. AidData at William & Mary.

Custer, S., Sethi, T., Knight, R., Hutchinson, A., Choo, V., and M. Cheng. (2021). *Listening to Leaders 2021: A report card for development partners in an era of contested cooperation.* Williamsburg, VA. AidData at William & Mary.

Custer, S., Schon, J., Horigoshi, A., Mathew, D., Burgess, B., Choo, V., Hutchinson, A., Baehr, A., and K. Marshall (2021). *Corridors of Power: How does Beijing exert influence along the Silk Road?* December 13, 2021. Williamsburg, VA. AidData at William & Mary.

Custer, S., Dreher, A., Elston, T.B., Fuchs, A., Ghose, S., Lin, J., Malik, A., Parks, B.C., Russell, B., Solomon, K., Strange, A., Tierney, M.J., Walsh, K., Zaleski, L., and Zhang, S. 2021. *Tracking Chinese Development Finance: An Application of AidData's TUFF 2.0 Methodology*. Williamsburg, VA: AidData at William & Mary.

AidData. 2022. China Global Public Diplomacy Indicators Dataset, Version 1.6.

This data file includes four separate datasets:

(1) Chinese Global Public Diplomacy: Country year format data on China's Global Public Diplomacy efforts
(2) AidData's Global Chinese Development Finance Dataset, Version 2.0: Project level data on China's Official Finance
(3) Perceptions: Contains measures of how China is perceived by leaders in low- and middle-income countries
(4) Confucius Institutes: Contains information on the operational status and location of individual Confucius Institutes

The dataset consists of variables collected from an array of sources and methods, including primary data collection carried out by AidData as well as extending existing measures pioneered by previous research.

Citation

AidData. (2022). China's Global Public Diplomacy Dashboard Dataset, Version 3.0. Retrieved from http://china-dashboard.aiddata.org

Data Coverage

Scope: Quantitative measures of China's global public diplomacy tools leveraged bilaterally.
Year Coverage: 1999-2021
Geographical Coverage: Global

Field Definitions

Chinese Public Diplomacy

Field Name	Definition
receiving_country	The country that imports or accepts the overtures from China to extend its influence outside its borders.
year	The year a public diplomacy tool is deployed to the receiving country from China.
confucius_institutes	Cumulative number of Confucius Institutes operating within each receiving country per year. Confucius Institutes (CIs) are non-profit, but government-operated organizations with the mandate to promote Chinese language and culture. CIs are usually set up as a partnership with a local university in the receiving country (or secondary schools in the case of Confucius Classrooms) and have the additional objective to promote local cooperation with Chinese businesses.
sister_cities	Cumulative number of Sister/Friendship Cities between cities or provinces in China and a city or province in the receiving country per year.
confucius_classrooms	The total number of Confucius Classrooms (CCs) operating in a receiving country each year.
outbound_political_visits	The total number of visits by heads of state and heads of government from China to target countries
inbound_political_visits	The total number of visits by heads of state and heads of government from target countries to China.
broader_cadre_visits	The total number of visits by a broader cadre of officials from China in working level meetings.
ccp_visits	The total number of visits to a target country by Chinese Communist Party (CCP) delegations.
ambassador_op_eds	Number of publications of op-eds written by the highest echelon of Chinese Ambassador in local media by country-year
journalist_visits	Number of journalistic exchange visits to China from EAP countries by country-year.
content_sharing_partnerships	Number of new content sharing partnerships established in a country in a given year.
outbound_chinese_students	Number of Chinese students studying in EAP by country-year
inbound_students_to_china	Number of international students studying in China by country-year
expert_deployments	The number of initiatives where Chinese experts were sent to the target country to serve as specialists on specific projects or to fill certain jobs.
joint_resource_developments	The number of public good projects developed between the PRC and the target country.
scholarships	The number of scholarship initiatives aimed directly at students including student exchange and university study in China.
training_programs	The number of professional and job training program initiatives, including in-country training and specific professional programs in China.

AidData's Global Chinese Development Finance Dataset, Version 2.0

Field Name	Definition
AidData TUFF Project ID	This field provides the unique identification number that AidData has assigned to every project record in the 2.0 version of the dataset. Whenever applicable, this number matches the identification number in AidData's Global Chinese Official Finance Dataset, Version 1.0
Recommended For Aggregates	This field identifies projects that AidData recommends including in analysis that requires the aggregation of projects supported by official financial (or in-kind) commitments from China, including analysis of monetary amounts and project counts. It is useful for identifying formally approved, active, and completed Chinese government-financed

	projects -- and excluding all canceled projects, suspended projects, and projects that never reached the formal approval (official commitment) stage. The field is set to "Yes" for all projects with a status designation of Pipeline: Commitment, Implementation, and Completion that have not also been designated as umbrella agreements. It is set to “No” for all canceled projects, suspended projects, and projects that never reached the official commitment stage (i.e., those projects with a status designation of Pipeline: Pledge, Suspended, and Canceled). Additionally, to avoid double-counting, the field is set to “No” for all umbrella agreements. For more information on umbrella agreements, see the description of the “Umbrella” field in this file. Also, note that not all projects with a “Recommended for Aggregates” value of “True” identify a financial transaction value (since some transactions are difficult to monetize, such as in-kind donations, technical assistance, scholarships, and training activities).
Umbrella	This field identifies projects as "umbrella" agreements (with a “Yes” designation) in two circumstances. The first circumstance is when a financial agreement was signed by at least one party in the donor/creditor country and one party in the receiving country, but funds were not allocated for a specific project/purpose (or set of projects/purposes) until a subsequent date. These types of umbrella agreements include Economic and Technical Cooperation Agreements (ECTA) issued by China’s Ministry of Commerce (MOFCOM), master facility agreements issued by China Eximbank, lines of credit issued by China Development Bank, and Framework Agreements issued by a variety of official sector institutions in China. Due to the nature of the TUFF data collection process, the subsidiary projects/transactions approved and financed under these types of umbrella agreements are likely captured elsewhere in the dataset. The second circumstance is when a single project is financed by multiple Chinese government or Chinese state-owned institutions. In these cases, AidData creates one umbrella record to record the full amount of the financial commitment for the project and a linked set of subsidiary project records to capture the respective financial commitments of each Chinese government or Chinese state-owned institution. All umbrella agreements in the dataset are assigned a designation of "No" in the "Recommended for Aggregates" field to help users avoid double counting.
Financier Country	This field captures the country from which the official financial or in-kind transfer originated.
Recipient	This field captures the country from which the entity receiving the official financial or in-kind transfer is located. If multiple entities from multiple recipient countries are involved, this field records the geographical region to which the recipient countries belong.
Recipient Region	This field captures the geographical region to which the recipient country belongs: Africa, Americas, Asia, Europe, Middle East, Oceania, or Multi-Region.
Commitment Year	This field captures the year in which an official financial commitment (or official commitment to provide in-kind support) was codified through the signing of a formal agreement by an official donor/lender in China and one or more entities in a recipient country or a set of recipient countries. In the event an official commitment was made for a project that entered implementation, but the official commitment year is not identifiable, AidData records the first year of project implementation as a proxy for the official commitment year. In the event an official commitment was made for a project that has not yet reached implementation, and the official commitment year is not identifiable, AidData records the year in which the underlying commercial contract (supported by the official commitment) was issued. If this information is unavailable, AidData records the first year in which an informal pledge was made as a proxy for the official commitment year. For projects with a status designation of Pipeline Pledge (i.e., cases in which an official commitment was not made), AidData records the year in which the informal pledge was made.
Commitment Year Estimated	For projects with a status designation of Pipeline: Commitment, Implementation, Completion, Suspended, and Canceled, this marker designates whether AidData estimated the commitment year or reported the actual year in which the official commitment was made. The field is set to "Yes" when the “Commitment Year” field is estimated by AidData. It is otherwise set to “No,” which indicates that AidData has reported the actual commitment year. For projects with a status designation of Pipeline Pledge, this marker designates whether AidData estimated the pledge year or reported the actual year in which the informal pledge was made.
Implementation Start Year	This field captures the year in which a project supported by an official financial (or in-kind) commitment from China began implementation. Whenever possible, this field is based on the precise calendar day when project implementation began, which is captured in the 'Actual Implementation Start Date' field. For projects that involve the construction of buildings or infrastructure, the 'Implementation Start Year' field seeks to capture the first

	year of construction. In cases when the first year of construction is unavailable but a proxy for the first year of construction (e.g., the year in which a formal groundbreaking ceremony took place, a project commencement order was issued to the contractor responsible for implementation, or a project implementation agreement was signed) can be identified, AidData records the proxy for the first year of construction. For projects that do not involve construction but involve the provision of personnel, training, analytical/advisory support, equipment, supplies, or commodities, the 'Implementation Start Year' field captures the first year in which some type of support was delivered to an entity in the recipient country. For projects that only involve financial transactions (e.g., cash donations, loans issued to shore up a country's foreign exchange reserves, forgiveness or rescheduling of outstanding debts), the 'Implementation Start Year' field captures the year in which the first disbursement was made (or the year in which new terms and conditions went into effect for a previously signed loan/export credit agreement).
Completion Year	This field captures the year in which a project supported by an official financial (or in-kind) commitment from China was completed. Whenever possible, this field is based on the precise calendar day when a project was completed, which is captured in the 'Actual Completion Date' field. For projects that involve the construction of buildings or infrastructure, the 'Completion Year' field seeks to capture the last year of construction. In cases when the last year of construction is unavailable but a proxy for the last year of construction (e.g., a road or railway is opened for use, a power plant reaches its commercial operation date and begins selling electricity to customers) can be identified, AidData records the proxy for the last year of construction. For projects that do not involve construction but involve the provision of personnel, training, analytical/advisory support, equipment, supplies, or commodities, the 'Completion Year' field captures the last year in which some type of support was delivered to an entity (or set of entities) in the recipient country. For projects that only involve financial transactions (cash donations, loans issued to shore up foreign exchange reserves, forgiveness or rescheduling of outstanding debts), the 'Completion Year' field captures the year in which the last disbursement was made (or the year in which new terms and conditions went into effect for a previously signed loan/export credit agreement).
Title	This field briefly describes the name or nature of the project. The identification numbers of other transactions that are linked to the project are also recorded in this field.
Description	This field provides a detailed summary of the main purposes and activities of the project; the funding, receiving, and implementing agencies involved in the project; the terms and conditions of the financial transaction(s) supporting the project; the timing of project implementation and completion; the challenges that arose during project implementation and how funding, receiving, and implementing agencies responded to these challenges; and main achievements and shortcomings of the project. For loan- and export credit-financed projects, AidData also records the monetary value and timing of underlying commercial contracts, disbursements, and repayments in this field.
Staff Comments	This field captures comments from AidData staff that clarify the assumptions, logic, and evidence used to address challenging coding and categorization determinations. It also provides foreign translations of project titles (used for source identification purposes), information about related projects/transactions, and information about the ownership structures of funding, receiving, and implementing agencies.
Status	This field identifies the latest status of a project. Each project is assigned to one of six categories: Pipeline: Pledge, Pipeline: Commitment, Implementation, Completed, Suspended, Canceled. A project assigned to the "Pipeline: Pledge" category is one that an official sector institution in China indicated it was interested in supporting (or willing to consider supporting) but did not result in an official commitment. Projects assigned to this category include those that are identified in letters of intent, term sheets, memoranda of understanding, and non-binding announcements. All projects given a status designation of Pipeline: Commitment, Implementation, Completed, Suspended, or Canceled reached the official commitment stage (i.e., a binding, written agreement that governs the provision of financial or in-kind support for a specific project/purpose was signed by an official sector donor or lender in China and an entity in a recipient country). A project assigned to the "Pipeline: Commitment" category is one that is backed by an official commitment but has not yet entered implementation. A project assigned to the "Implementation" category is one that is backed by an official commitment and has begun implementation with financial or in-kind support from the source of the commitment. A project assigned to the "Completion" category is one that is backed by an official commitment and that reached completion with financial or in-kind support from the sources of the commitment. Projects assigned to the "Suspended" and "Canceled" categories are those that were backed by an

	official commitment but subsequently suspended or canceled. The coding of the "Status" field in the 2.0 dataset is based on sources that were available as late as August 2021.
Intent	This field seeks to measure the primary purpose of the project. Each project is assigned to one of five categories: Development, Commercial, Representational, Mixed, or Military. Projects assigned to the "Development" category are those that are primarily oriented towards the promotion of economic development and welfare in the recipient country. Projects assigned to the "Commercial" category are those that primarily seek to promote the commercial interests of the country from which the financial transfer originated (e.g., encouraging the export of Chinese goods and services). Projects assigned to the "Representational" category are those that primarily seek to promote a bilateral relationship with another country or promote the language, culture, or values of the country from which the financial transfer originated (e.g., the establishment of a Confucius Institute or Chinese cultural center). If a project is assigned to the "Mixed" category, this designation indicates that it was not possible for AidData to identify the primary purpose of the project and the project has multiple purposes (i.e., some combination of development, commercial, and/or representational intent). Projects assigned to the "Military" category are those that seek to promote the security interests of the country from which the financial transfer originates or strengthen the capabilities of military institutions in the recipient country.
Flow Type	This field captures the type of financial or in-kind transfer supporting the project. Each project is assigned to one of nine categories: Loan, Export Buyer's Credit, Supplier's Credit/Export Seller's Credit, Debt Forgiveness, Debt Rescheduling, Grant, Scholarships/Training in Donor Country, Freestanding Technical Assistance, and Vague (TBD). In cases of debt forgiveness, the Umbrella field is set to "Yes" if the original contracted loan could be captured elsewhere in the dataset as a loan project record. This is done to avoid double counting. If the original contracted loans occurred before 2000 (when the dataset begins to track Chinese Development Finance), then the Umbrella field is set to "No." As such, if users are interested in isolating all cases of debt forgiveness, AidData recommends turning the "Recommended for Aggregates" filter off and then using the "Flow Type" field to identify all projects assigned to the "Debt Forgiveness" category (irrespective of whether they are coded as umbrella projects). Also, to help users avoid double-counting, AidData does not populate any fields related to transaction amounts [Amount (Original Currency), Original Currency Amount (Constant USD2017), Amount (Nominal)] for projects assigned to the "Debt Rescheduling" category. However, users who wish to undertake analysis of debt reschedulings can find detailed information about the terms and conditions of these reschedulings in the "Description" fields of the projects that are assigned to the "Debt Rescheduling" category.
Concessional	This marker designates whether the flow is concessional in nature or not. For loan- and export credit-financed projects, this marker identifies whether the loan terms were provided on concessional terms or not. The concessionality determination is based on OECD's grant element calculator and 25% grant element threshold. For grants, scholarships, technical assistance, training activities, and debt forgiveness, the concessional marker is set to "Yes". If the concessionality is unknown, this marker is set to "vague".
Flow Class	Based on OECD-DAC guidelines for Official Development Assistance (ODA) and Other Official Flows (OOF), this field assigns projects to one of three categories: ODA-like, OOF-like, Vague (Official Finance). Projects are assigned to the ODA-Like category if they meet three criteria. First, the primary purpose of the project must be the promotion of economic development and welfare in the recipient country (i.e., have development intent). Second, the official commitment supporting the project must be concessional in nature (i.e., grant, technical assistance, scholarship, debt forgiveness, or loan with a grant element of at least 25%). Third, the project must take place in a country that qualifies for ODA based on its income level. Projects that are supported by an official financial or in-kind transfer but do not meet all three of these criteria are assigned to the OOF-Like category. Projects that are backed by an official commitment but cannot be reliably categorized as ODA-like or OOF-like because of insufficiently detailed information are assigned to the "Vague (Official Finance)" category. Projects in this residual category primarily consist of (a) those with an unspecified "Flow Type" (i.e., values of "Vague TBD"); and (b) those financed with development-intent loans for which AidData lacks the borrowing terms (interest rates, grace periods, or maturity dates) needed to concessionality determinations.
Sector Code	This field provides a 3-digit sector code based upon the primary sectoral focus of the project. It is based upon the OECD's sector categorization scheme. There are 24, three-digit OECD sector codes: education (110), health (120), population policies/programs and

	reproductive health (130), water supply and sanitation (140), government and civil society (150), other social infrastructure and services (160), transport and storage (210), communications (220), energy (230), banking and financial services (240), business and other services (250), agriculture, forestry and fishing (310), industry, mining, and construction (320), trade policies and regulation (330), general environmental protection (410), other multisector (430), general budget support (510), developmental food aid/food security assistance (520), other commodity assistance (530), action relating to debt (600), emergency response (720), reconstruction relief and rehabilitation (730), disaster prevention and preparedness (740), and unallocated/unspecified (998).
Sector Name	This field provides a sector name based upon the primary sectoral focus of the project. It is based upon the OECD's sector categorization scheme. There are 24, three-digit OECD sector codes: education (110), health (120), population policies/programs and reproductive health (130), water supply and sanitation (140), government and civil society (150), other social infrastructure and services (160), transport and storage (210), communications (220), energy (230), banking and financial services (240), business and other services (250), agriculture, forestry and fishing (310), industry, mining, and construction (320), trade policies and regulation (330), general environmental protection (410), other multisector (430), general budget support (510), developmental food aid/food security assistance (520), other commodity assistance (530), action relating to debt (600), emergency response (720), reconstruction relief and rehabilitation (730), disaster prevention and preparedness (740), and unallocated/unspecified (998).
Funding Agencies	This field captures the name of the agency that issued the official financial or in-kind commitment. The agency identified in this field must be based in the country (the People's Republic of China) from which the official financial or in-kind commitment originated. For projects assigned to the Pipeline: Pledge category, this field captures the name of the official sector agency that issued the pledge. The same "origin rule" applies to funding agencies that issued pledges rather than commitments. If multiple Chinese funding agencies are involved, the entries are pipe-delimited.
Funding Agencies Type	This field captures the type of funding agency that issued the commitment or pledge. Each project is assigned to one of six categories: Government Agency, State-Owned Policy Bank, State-Owned Commercial Bank, State-Owned Bank, State-Owned Company, and State-Owned Fund.
Cofinanced	This marker indicates whether a separate funding agency (belonging to the financier country or another country) provided funding for the project.
Co Financing Agencies	This field provides the names of the co financing agencies providing funding for the project. If multiple co financing agencies are involved, the entries are pipe delimited.
Co Financing Agencies Type	This field captures the type of co financing agency that provided funding. Each co-financing agency is assigned to one of twelve categories: Government Agency, State-Owned Bank, State-Owned Policy Bank, State-Owned Commercial Bank, State-Owned Company, State-Owned Fund, Intergovernmental Organization, Special Purpose Vehicle/Joint Venture, Private Sector, NGO/CSO/Foundation, Other, or No Organization Type Specified.
Co Financing Agencies Origin	This field indicates the origin of the co-financing agency with respect to whether it is from the financier country, the recipient country, or another country. Each co-financing agency is assigned to one of the following categories: China, Recipient Country, or Other.
Receiving Agencies	This field provides the name of the agency designated to receive and manage the financial or in-kind transfer. For projects that are financed with loans or export credits, the receiving agency is the entity responsible for debt repayment. If a receiving agency (borrower) on-lends to the proceeds of a loan or export credit to an additional entity or entities, all entities with formal repayment responsibilities are identified in the "Receiving Agency" field (as pipe-delimited entries). Likewise, if more than one entity is responsible for receiving and managing an incoming grant or an in-kind transfer, all of these entities are identified in the "Receiving Agency" field (as pipe-delimited entries).
Receiving Agencies Type	This field captures the type of agency designated to receive and manage the incoming financial or in-kind transfer. Each receiving agency is assigned to one of ten categories: Government Agency, State-Owned Bank, State-Owned Company, State-Owned Fund, Intergovernmental Organization, Special Purpose Vehicle/Joint Venture, Private Sector, NGO/CSO/Foundation, Other, or No Organization Type Specified.
Receiving Agencies Origin	This field indicates the origin of the receiving agency with respect to whether it is from the financier country, the recipient country, or another country. Each receiving agency is assigned to one of the following categories: China, Recipient Country, or Other.
Implementing Agencies	This field provides the name of the agency responsible for implementing the project activities. If more than one agency is responsible for implementing the project activities,

	all such agencies are identified in the "Implementing Agencies" field (as pipe-delimited entries).
Implementing Agencies Type	This field captures the type of agency responsible for implementing the project activities. Each implementing agency is assigned to one of ten categories: Government Agency, State-Owned Bank, State-Owned Company, State-Owned Fund, Intergovernmental Organization, Special Purpose Vehicle/Joint Venture, Private Sector, NGO/CSO/Foundation, Other, or No Organization Type Specified.
Implementing Agencies Origin	This field indicates the origin of the implementing agency with respect to whether it is from the financier country, the recipient country, or another country. Each receiving agency is assigned to one of the following categories: China, Recipient Country, or Other.
Accountable Agencies	This field provides the name of any agency other than the receiving agency that has a contractual obligation to ensure that the official creditor (i.e. funding agency) directly or indirectly recovers the funds it lent to the receiving agency. These "accountable agencies" include any third-parties that (i) provide a repayment guarantee in the event the borrower (i.e. receiving agency) cannot service its debt; (ii) issue a credit insurance policy to ensure repayment in the event the borrower cannot service its debt; or (iii) pledge one or more sources of collateral that can be seized in the event the borrower defaults on its repayment obligations. If more than one agency other than the receiving agency has a contractual obligation to ensure that the official creditor recovers the funds it lent to the receiving agency, all of these agencies are identified in the "Accountable Agencies" field as pipe-delimited entries.
Accountable Agencies Type	This field captures the type of accountable agency that has a contractual obligation to ensure that the official creditor (i.e., funding agency) directly or indirectly recovers the funds it lent to the receiving agency. Each accountable agency is assigned to one of ten categories: Government Agency, State-Owned Bank, State-Owned Company, State-Owned Fund, Intergovernmental Organization, Special Purpose Vehicle/Joint Venture, Private Sector, NGO/CSO/Foundation, Other, or No Organization Type Specified.
Accountable Agencies Origin	This field indicates the origin of the accountable agency with respect to whether it is from the financier country, the recipient country, or another country. Each accountable agency is assigned to one of the following categories: China, Recipient Country, or Other.
Amount (Original Currency)	This field captures the monetary amount that the funding agency committed (or pledged) in its original currency of denomination. For projects that were at some point supported by an official commitment (i.e., projects with status designations of Pipeline: Commitment, Implementation, Completed, Suspended, Canceled), this field captures the original commitment amount. For projects with status designations of Pipeline: Pledge, this field captures the amount of funding that was pledged.
Original Currency	This field captures that currency of denomination associated with the monetary amount that the funding agency committed (or pledged), as recorded in the Amount (Original Currency) field.
Amount (Constant USD2017)	This field captures the monetary value of the official commitment (or pledge) issued by the funding agency in constant 2017 U.S. dollars. To calculate this value, AidData first converts the financial commitment (or pledge) amount in its original currency of denomination to nominal U.S. dollars at the average exchange rate in effect during the commitment (or pledge) year, and then converts this amount to constant 2017 U.S. dollars using the OECD's deflation methodology to adjust for inflation and ensure comparability over time and space (see Appendix D for details).
Amount (Nominal)	This field captures the monetary value of the official commitment (or pledge) issued by the funding agency in nominal U.S. dollars. It is one of the inputs used to calculate financial commitment (and pledge) amounts in constant 2017 U.S. dollars, as recorded in the Amount (Constant USD2017) field.
Planned Implementation Start Date (MM/DD/YYYY)	This field captures the day on which a project supported by an official financial (or in-kind) commitment from China was originally scheduled to begin implementation. Whenever possible, this field is based on the precise calendar day when the project was originally scheduled to begin implementation. However, in cases when AidData is only able to identify the month and year in which project implementation was scheduled to begin (e.g., May 2018), the "Planned Implementation Start Date" field is set to the first day of the month (e.g., 05/01/2018).
Planned Completion Date (MM/DD/YYYY)	This field captures the calendar day on which a project supported by an official financial (or in-kind) commitment from China was originally scheduled to reach completion. Whenever possible, this field is based on the precise calendar day when the project was originally scheduled to reach completion. However, in cases when AidData is only able to identify the month and year in which a project was scheduled to reach completion (e.g., May

	2018), the "Planned Completion Start Date" field is set to the first day of the month (e.g., 05/01/2018).
Actual Implementation Start Date (MM/DD/YYYY)	This field captures the calendar day on which a project supported by an official financial (or in-kind) commitment from China began implementation. Whenever possible, this field is based on the precise calendar day when project implementation began. However, in cases when AidData is only able to identify the month and year in which project implementation began (e.g., May 2018), the "Actual Implementation Start Date" field is set to the first day of the month (e.g., 05/01/2018). For projects that involve the construction of buildings or infrastructure, the "Actual Implementation Start Date" field seeks to capture the first day of construction. In cases when the first day of construction is unavailable but a proxy for the first day of construction (e.g., the date on which a formal groundbreaking ceremony took place, a project commencement order was issued to the contractor responsible for implementation, or a project implementation agreement was signed) can be identified, AidData records the proxy for the first date of construction. For projects that do not involve construction but involve the provision of personnel, training, analytical/advisory support, equipment, supplies, or commodities, the "Actual Implementation Start Date" field captures the first day in which some type of support was delivered to an entity (or set of entities) in the recipient country. For projects that only involve financial transactions (cash donations, loans issued to shore up a country's foreign exchange reserves, forgiveness or rescheduling of outstanding debts), the "Actual Implementation Start Date" field captures the day on which the first disbursement was made (or the day on which new terms and conditions went into effect for a previously signed loan/export credit agreement).
Actual Completion Date (MM/DD/YYYY)	This field captures the calendar day on which a project supported by an official financial (or in-kind) commitment from China was completed. Whenever possible, this field is based on the precise calendar day when a project was completed. However, in cases when AidData is only able to identify the month and year in which a project was completed (e.g., May 2018), the "Actual Completion Date" field is set to the first day of the month (e.g., 05/01/2018). For projects that involve the construction of buildings or infrastructure, the "Actual Completion Date" field seeks to capture the last day of construction. In cases when the last day of construction is unavailable but a proxy for the last day of construction (e.g., a road or railway is opened for use, a power plant reaches its commercial operation date and begins selling electricity to customers) is available, AidData records the proxy for the last day of construction. For projects that do not involve construction but involve the provision of personnel, training, analytical/advisory support, equipment, supplies, or commodities, the "Actual Completion Date" field captures the last day on which some type of support was delivered to an entity (or set of entities) in the recipient country. For projects that only involve financial transactions (cash donations, loans issued to shore up foreign exchange reserves, forgiveness or rescheduling of outstanding debts), the "Actual Completion Date" field captures the day on which the last disbursement was made (or the day on which new terms and conditions went into effect for a previously signed loan/export credit agreement).
Loan Type	For loan- and export credit-financed projects, this field captures the nature of the debt that was issued. This field has five different categories: Interest-Free, Concessional, Non-Concessional, No Information, and Some Information.
Maturity	This field captures the total number of years it will take the borrower to repay a loan or export credit, as specified in the original loan or export credit agreement. Maturity lengths are inclusive of grace periods. In cases when a loan or export credit's maturity is modified after an official commitment is issued, AidData captures the maturity modification through a separate record in the dataset that is given a flow type designation of "Debt Rescheduling."
Interest Rate	This field captures the rate of interest (in percentage terms) that applies to a loan or export credit, as specified in the original loan or export credit agreement. In cases when the interest rate is tied to a floating rate such as LIBOR or EURIBOR, AidData calculates the value of the floating rate in the month (or year) when the official commitment was issued. In cases when a loan or export credit's interest rate is modified after an official commitment is issued, AidData captures the interest rate modification through a separate record in the dataset that is given a flow type designation of "Debt Rescheduling."
Grace Period	This field captures the number of years for which the borrower (receiving agency) is not expected to make principal repayments to the creditor (funding agency), as specified in the original loan or export credit agreement. In cases when a loan or export credit's grace period is modified after an official commitment is issued, AidData captures the grace

	period modification through a separate record in the dataset that is given a flow type designation of "Debt Rescheduling."
Management Fee	This field captures the management fee (in percentage terms) that applies to the loan or export credit, as specified in the original loan or export credit agreement. A management fee is a one-time, lump sum fee that is charged as a percentage of the face value of the loan. In cases when a loan or export credit's management fee is modified after an official commitment is issued, AidData captures the management fee modification through a separate record in the dataset that is given a flow type designation of "Debt Rescheduling."
Commitment Fee	This field captures the commitment fee (in percentage terms) that applies to the loan or export credit, as specified in the original loan or export credit agreement. A commitment fee is a fee that a borrower must pay to compensate the lender for its commitment to lend; it is usually payable semi-annually and the size of the fee is usually based on a fixed percentage of the undisbursed loan amount. In cases when a loan or export credit's commitment fee is modified after an official commitment is issued, AidData captures the commitment fee modification through a separate record in the dataset that is given a flow type designation of "Debt Rescheduling."
Grant Element	The field captures the grant element of the loan or export credit, at the time that the original loan or export credit agreement was signed. To calculate the grant element of a loan or export credit, which is a measure that varies from 0 percent to 100 percent, one needs to calculate the discounted cost (or "net present value") of the future debt service payments that will be made by the borrower. This calculation requires information about the loan or export credit's face value, maturity length, grace period, and interest rate. When AidData has access to loan or export credit's face value, maturity length, grace period, and interest rate, it uses the OECD's grant element calculator (assuming a fixed, 10 percent discount, 2 repayments per year, and equal principal repayments). In theory, a grant element calculator can generate values above 100% or below 0%. However, AidData bounds grant element values so that they cannot assume negative values (since negative values imply lending terms that are "less favorable than market terms," which is nonsensical if market terms are risk-adjusted prices agreed by willing buyers and sellers of credit) or values that exceed 100%. In cases when AidData does not have access to enough information to use the OECD's grant element calculator but the sources that underpin the project record identify a grant element estimate, AidData records the grant element estimate in this field.
Guarantee Provided	This field provides a marker of whether it is known that a loan or export credit repayment guarantee was issued by a third-party (accountable agency). It assumes a value of "Yes" whenever a sovereign or corporate guarantee is issued in support of a loan or export credit.
Insurance Provided	This field provides a marker of whether it is known that a third-party (accountable agency) issued a credit insurance policy to the borrower (receiving agency). For example, it assumes a value of "Yes" whenever a loan or export credit is backed by a credit insurance policy issued by China Export & Credit Insurance Corporation (SInosure).
Collateralized/Securitized	This field provides a marker of whether it is known that one or more sources of collateral (security) can be seized in the event the borrower defaults on its loan/export credit repayment obligations. It assumes a value of "Yes" when (i) a loan/export credit is collateralized through a formal lien or security interest; (ii) a borrower is required to deposit project-related revenues or unrelated revenues in a special account, escrow account, or revenue account that can be accessed (and debited) by the lender; and/or (iii) a security agent is appointed (to enforce rights against the collateral in the event that the borrower defaults on its repayment obligations). AidData also codes all pre-export finance (PXF) facilities as collateralized since they are almost always secured by (1) an assignment of rights by the producer under an 'offtake contract' (i.e., a sale and purchase contract between the producer and a buyer of that producer of goods or commodities), and (2) a collection account charge over a bank account into which proceeds due to the producer from the buyer of the goods or commodities under the offtake contract are credited.
Collateral	This field describes the nature of the collateral (security) that can be seized in the event the borrower defaults on its loan/export credit repayment obligations.
Official Source Count	This field provides a count of the total number of official sources used to create the project record. Official source types include Donor/Recipient Official Source Implementing/Intermediary Organization Source, and Other Official Source (non-Donor, non-Recipient, non-Implementing).
Non-Official Source Count	This field provides a count of the total number of non-official sources used to create the project record. Non-Official source types include NGO/Civil Society/Advocacy (non-Donor,

	non-Recipient, non-Implementing), Media Report, Social Media, including Unofficial Blogs, Academic Journal Article, and Other Academic (Working Paper, Dissertation), and Other.
Source URLs	This field provides URLs to the sources that were used to create the project record. The entries are pipe delimited
Source Titles	This field provides the titles of the source articles, reports, and websites used to create the project record. The entries are pipe delimited.
Source Publishers	This field provides the names of the publishers of the source articles, reports, and websites used to create the project record. The entries are pipe delimited.
Source Type	This field identifies the type of sources that were used to create the project record. The entries are pipe delimited.
Geographic Location	This field provides a description of the geographical locations of project activities. Whenever possible, AidData captures geographical information that makes it possible to identify (i) the precise physical boundaries and exact locations of buildings and facilities (e.g. schools, hospitals, stadiums, government buildings, power plants, and factories) with polygons or points; (ii) the precise geographical scope of special economic zones, industrial parks, mining concessions, protected areas, and plots of land under cultivation via polygons or points; and (iii) the exact routes of linear infrastructure (e.g., roads, bridges, tunnels, railways, power lines, canals, and pipelines) via line vectors. Whenever possible, AidData also records OpenStreetMap and GoogleMaps URLs that capture the geographical locations and features of projects. An important caveat is that AidData is only able to provide these types of geographical details for the subset of projects in the 2.0 dataset that have physical footprints (e.g., roads, railways, transmission lines) or involve activities at specific locations (e.g., medical teams stationed at a given hospital, equipment given to park rangers to patrol a protected area).
geoJSON URL Viz	This field provides stable URLs where users can view the geoJSON visualizations associated with each geographical location/feature of the project (when such information is available). These geoJSON shapefiles were constructed by AidData by using the OpenStreetMap URLs that are recorded in the "Geographic Location" field. AidData has made the complete set of GeoJSON files along with usage tips, and related documentation accessible via https://github.com/aiddata/china-osm-geodata
geoJSON URL DL	This field provides stable URLs where users can download the geoJSON shapefiles associated with each geographical location/feature of the project (when such information is available). These geoJSON shapefiles were constructed by AidData by using the OpenStreetMap URLs that are recorded in the "Geographic Location" field. AidData has made the complete set of GeoJSON files along with usage tips, and related documentation accessible via https://github.com/aiddata/china-osm-geodata
Contact Name	This field records the names of the people who were involved in the project and/or the financial (or in-kind) transfer for the project whenever this information is available.
Contact Position	This field records the position titles of the people who were involved in the project and/or the financial (or in-kind) transfer for the project whenever this information is available.
ODA Eligible Recipient	This field designates whether the recipient country was eligible for ODA (based on income level and OECD DAC categorizations) in the year that the official commitment was issued. For projects with a status designation of "Pipeline: Pledge," this field designates whether the recipient country was eligible for ODA (based on income level and OECD DAC categorizations) in the year that the informal pledge was issued.
Source Quality Score	This metric varies on a scale of 1 to 5, with 1 indicating that the project record is exclusively underpinned by unofficial sources and 5 indicating reliance upon multiple, official sources.
Data Completeness Score	This metric varies on a scale of 0 to 5, with 5 indicating that the basic fields of the project record are complete. The "threshold" for a score of 5 is similar to the key fields in the OECD-DAC's Creditor Reporting System: an actual rather than estimated commitment year, a non-missing transaction amount, a flow type/flow class that is not defined as "Vague", and identifiable funding, implementing, and receiving agencies.
Project Implementation Score	This metric varies on a scale of 0 to 5, with higher scores indicating that more implementation details have been captured in the project record. The following implementation details are considered: whether the project's implementing agency (or agencies), implementation start and completion dates (actual or planned), and geographical locations are specified; and whether the project has a specified sector allocation. Project Implementation Scores are only calculated for project records with a "Recommended for Aggregates" value of "True" and a "Status" value of "Implementation" or "Completion.
Loan Detail Score	This metric varies on a scale of 0-5, with higher values indicating that more financial transaction details are captured in the project record. Loan Detail Scores are only

calculated for project records with a “Recommended for Aggregates” value of “True” and a “Flow Type” designation of “Loan,” “Export Buyer’s Credit,” or “Supplier's Credit/Export Seller's Credit.” A score of 5 indicates that a loan or export credit’s interest rate, maturity, transaction value, loan type, funding agencies, and receiving agencies are all specified (i.e., not missing).

Perceptions

Field Name	Definition
receiving_region	The region where survey respondents are based
perceptions_of_influence	% of leaders who said a development partner was quite (3) or very influential (4) in shaping domestic policy priorities
positivity	The average positivity score leaders gave a development partner's influence, ranging from "very negative" (1) to "very positive" (4)
perceptions_of_helpfulness	% of leaders who said a development partner was quite (3) or very helpful (4) in implementing policy changes

Confucius Institutes

Field Name	Definition
region	The region where the country hosting the Confucius Institute is located. The regions are indicated as Africa (AF), East Asia and the Pacific (EAP), Europe and Eurasia (EUR), North Africa and Middle East (NEA), South and Central Asia (SCA), and Western Hemisphere (WH).
country	The country where the Confucius Institute is located.
location_of_space	The city or town where the Confucius Institute is located.
name_of_space	The name of the specific Confucius Institute.
status	The current operating status of the Confucius Institute. All are noted as being in operation, closed, temporarily closed, or under development.
host_institution_name	The institution where the Confucius Institute is being hosted.
year_opened	The year that the Confucius Institute officially opened.
year_closed	The year the Confucius Institute officially closed. Confucius Institutes that are continuing to operate are marked as In Operation.

Files Included

The China's Global Public Diplomacy Dataset (version 3.0) is made available in a zipped file with the following files:

File Name	Description
ChinesePublicDiplomacy	CSV or Excel spreadsheet containing the country-year public diplomacy measures from China to recipient countries.
ChinasFinancialDiplomacyProjectDetails	CSV or Excel spreadsheet containing project-level details for all financial diplomacy flows.
Perceptions	CSV or Excel spreadsheet containing details on perceptions of China as a development partner from *Listening to Leaders 2021*.
ConfuciusInstitutes	CSV or Excel spreadsheet containing details on the location and operational status of Confucius Institutes.
README.pdf	The accompanying readme file (or codebook) describing the parameters of the dataset, caveats, and suggested uses.
AidData_Geocoding-Methodology-updated-2017-06.PDF	This file contains the methodology used to geocode the financial data for the South and Central Asia region

Sources and Methodology

Below are the various quantitative measures used in the China Global Public Diplomacy Dashboard and their corresponding sources.

Instrument of Influence	Description
Cultural Diplomacy	Includes activities to promote awareness of and sympathy for Chinese culture and values among policy elites, the general public, or specific subgroups of interest
Elite to Elite Diplomacy	Includes high-level visits by the PRC government, military, and other elite officials; and invitations for receiving country elites to visit elites in China
Exchange Diplomacy	Includes activities to socialize prospective future leaders from the receiving country regarding the sending country's political or professional norms and values, as well as cultivate personal relationships
Informational Diplomacy	Includes communications activities that powers undertake to cultivate influence by attracting foreign publics to empathize with its preferred narrative and adopt its views
Financial Diplomacy	Includes highly visible goodwill investments, and includes funding similar to official development assistance (ODA), which is defined by the OECD Development Assistance Committee (DAC) as "government aid that promotes and specifically targets the economic development and welfare of developing countries." Although China does not report its official finance to the DAC, the official financing visualized includes those comparable financial terms. This includes direct support to the receiving country through national budget support, debt relief/restructuring, humanitarian relief programs, and investments in infrastructure.

Instrument of Influence	Illustrative Indicator	Years Available	Description	Sources

Cultural Diplomacy	Confucius Institutes	2004-2021	The number of Confucius Institutes opened in a recipient country	AidData's China Global Public Diplomacy Indicators Dataset, Version 1.6
	Confucius Classrooms	2010-2018	The number of Confucius Classrooms opened in a recipient country	
Elite to Elite Diplomacy	Visits by PRC Heads of State and Heads of Government	2010-2019	The number of visits by the President or Premier of the PRC to a recipient country	AidData's China Global Public Diplomacy Indicators Dataset, Version 1.6
	Visits by Recipient Country Heads State and Heads of Government		The total number of visits by a head of state or head of government to the PRC	
	Visits by a Broader Cadre of PRC Officials		The number of visits by a broader cadre of officials from the PRC in working level meetings to recipient countries	
	Visits by a CCP Delegations		The number of visits by Chinese Communist Party (CCP) delegations to recipient countries	
Exchange Diplomacy	Sister Cities	2000-2018	The number of new sister city agreements between cities or provinces in a receiving country and the PRC	AidData's publications *Ties That Bind* and *Corridors of Power* Original sources include: *China International Friendship City Association (CIFCA)*
	Outbound Student Exchange	2010-2020	The number of tertiary level Chinese students that studied in a recipient country	AidData's China Global Public Diplomacy Indicators Dataset, Version 1.6 Original sources include: *UNESCO UIS* and *China Foreign Affairs Yearbooks*
	Inbound Student Exchange	2010-2017	The number of tertiary level students from recipient countries that studied in the PRC	
Informational Diplomacy	Ambassador Op-Eds	2002-2017	The number of publications of op-eds written by the PRC ambassador in receiving country media	AidData's publication *Influencing the Narrative*
	Journalist Visits	2002-2017	The number of journalistic exchange visits to the PRC	AidData's publications *Silk Road Diplomacy* and *Influencing the Narrative*
	Content Sharing Partnerships	1999-2021	The number of new content sharing partnerships established between PRC state run media and recipient country outlets	AidData's China Global Public Diplomacy Indicators Dataset, Version 1.6 Original sources include: Emily Feng (2018). China and the world: how Beijing spreads the

				message. July 12. Financial Times. Retrieved from: https://on.ft.com/2NMw74w
Financial Diplomacy	Official Finance	2000-2017	The value of the known universe of projects (with development, commercial, or representational intent) supported by official financial and in-kind commitments (or pledges) from the PRC. This includes the subset of funding for projects defined as Financial Diplomacy above.	AidData's Global Chinese Development Finance Dataset, Version 2.0
Other	Technical Assistance	2010-2020	The total amount of new and renewed PRC technical assistance initiatives occurring in a country in a given year.	AidData's China Global Public Diplomacy Indicators Dataset, Version 1.6

Glossary

Chinese Official Finance: Concessional and non-concessional funding from Chinese government institutions (including central, state or local government institutions) with development, commercial, or representational intent.

Official Development Assistance (ODA): A project that is primarily aimed at development, has a concessionality level (e.g. grant element) of at least 25%, and the recipient is ODA eligible (as defined by the OECD, based on country income level). This definition is aligned with the OECD Development Assistance Committee Directives. For a project to be categorized as ODA in our database, the intent field must be set to "Development", and the flow type field must be a grant, grant-like (e.g. scholarships, technical cooperation), or a concessional loan. In our dataset, these flows are categorized as "ODA-like".

Other Official Flows (OOF): A project that does not meet the criteria for ODA, because it is not primarily focused on development, it is insufficiently concessional (e.g., grant element less than 25%), or is being provided to a country that is not eligible for ODA. This definition is aligned with the OECD Development Assistance Committee 2014-2015 Directives. Projects in this category include those where the intent is primarily commercial or representational, and/or projects that are not concessional enough to qualify as ODA. This category includes export credits. In our dataset, these flows are categorized as "OOF-like".

Vague Official Finance: This flow class captures officially financed projects where there was not enough information about the project's concessionality level or intent to make a clear ODA or OOF determination. The OECD-DAC does not require this type of residual category because its members systematically report the intent and concessionality level of their officially-financed projects.

Public Diplomacy: A collection of instruments used by state and non-state actors from a 'sending' country with at least some intention of influencing the perceptions, preferences, and actions of foreign citizens in a 'receiving' country in favor of the 'sending' country's values, culture, and worldview.

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